

1945, May 21

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the
Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.
(from a carbon copy)

SAINT BONAVENTURA MONASTERY.
DETROIT MICHIGAN
May 21st 1945

V. Sister Mary Joseph.

Sisters of Saint Francis, LaFayette, Indiana.

Dear Sister Mary Joseph:

God bless you and yours. Praised be His Holy Name in all His unsearchable designs! I read your pathetic letter this morning and again just now. Yours is certainly a peculiar case. But after all, whose case is not a peculiar one? As no two grains of sand can be found exactly alike on all the strands of the oceans and as "star differeth from star in glory", so the ups and downs of this "life". So too the rainbows, the sun bursts, gentle breezes and the real Hellstorms we are liable to meet before, by the grace of God, we shall be able to tumble into our graves with the confidence of tired Children into their places of peaceful slumbers.

But dear Sister; we are never justified in being "bitter" toward anyone except ourselves. In very deed, if we were only one tenth as appreciative as we have every reason to be; our gratitude for what God has done for us - directly and through His creatures, most especially through our immediate superiors, - would be such that we would be perfectly content with what we are and what we have, without ever dreaming of what others may be in themselves, or what in all the world we may have "missed". Furthermore, to ever hope for really "true happiness" this side of Heaven has been always vain. only a dream Hence Father Ryan, the "Blind Poet of the South in his "Song of The Mystic": "...I walked in the world with the worldly. I craved what the world never gave "And I said: 'In the world each ideal that shines like a star on life's wave; "Is wrecked on the shores of the real(ity), and sleeps like dream in a grave. The peace, etc promised by the world is the peace of the Serpent - ahellofapeace. Ofcourse, there is such a thing as getting "a taste of Heaven" in this world, as we see clearly in the lives of many saints. But that is only possible - and its up to each of us to strive for - in as much as our virtue of Hope is inspired by Faith in God and strengthened -sweetened - in confidence of His great, merciful goodness. But O! "to enjoy life in the world" is another thing.

How long your Great....Grandmother Eve dilidallied with Satan before she finally reached for the fatal apple, Holy Scripture does not tell. If it were a hundred years, which is easily probable, she would have enjoyed the original Paradise ten times as long as you've been a nun. Had she listened to reason and been appreciative for her creation and the unsullied faculties that graced her soul and caused all on earth and in Heaven to smile in her direction, she would never have had time to give way to unprofitable curiosity or to discontent that the devil never fails to foster in our tainted nature.

But alas! ! ! Poor Eve's sad story! Poor Humanity's sorrows! Ingratitude!